ordering it to undertake a long and costly deployment and then opting for retreat, leaving the Pakistanis unpunished. As a senior American defense official stationed in New Delhi puts it, Indian commanders “were frustrated. . . . They really wanted to go after Pakistan but couldn’t.”[70]

In order to prevent a recurrence of Parakram’s failures, the Indians began to formulate a new Cold Start military doctrine, which will enable India to launch a large-scale offensive against Pakistan within seventy-two to ninety-six hours of a mobilization order. The doctrine will augment the offensive capabilities of India’s traditionally defensive holding formations located close to the Indo-Pakistani border. It will also eventually shift offensive strike corps from their current locations in the Indian hinterland to bases closer to Pakistan. In the event of conflict, Cold Start would drive three to five division-size integrated battle groups (IBGs)—consisting of armor, mechanized infantry, and artillery—twelve to fifty miles into Pakistan along the length of the international border. The IBGs would aggressively engage Pakistani forces and seize a long, shallow swath of Pakistani territory. Cold Start would seek to achieve three goals: inflict significant attrition on enemy forces; retain Pakistani territory for use as a postconflict bargaining chip; and, by limiting the depth of Indian incursions, avoid triggering a Pakistani strategic nuclear response. Indian military planners hope these doctrinal changes, coupled with India’s growing conventional military capabilities, will result in a more nimble force that is able to prevent a repetition of Parakram.[71]

Cold Start is currently in its nascent stages.[72] But the doctrine’s continued development and implementation will likely have two major effects. First, it will probably exacerbate regional security-dilemma dynamics. Pakistan has always been a deeply insecure state. Formerly, Pakistanis could expect India’s lengthy mobilization schedule to mitigate its military advantages. In the future this may not be the case. As a result, Pakistan will have to maintain a higher state of readiness,[73] and will face incentives to offset Indian strategic advances through increased arms racing and asymmetric warfare. Such behavior could trigger aggressive Indian responses, which would further heighten Pakistani insecurity. These dynamics could